13

FOLDING AND PRESSING GARMENTS

13.1 INTRODUCTION

It is important to press a garment for it to look good. However well a garment may have been made, the final finished look comes only after pressing it. Tailors even press the fabric at various stages during garment making. There are some garments whose cut components have to be individually pressed. Garments like pant and shirt need to be pressed at each stage of construction. After the garment is ready, it is finally pressed and then folded and packed. Hence, one must have adequate knowledge of all three stages of pressing, folding and packing.

13.2 OBJECTIVES

After reading this lesson, you will be able to :

- explain the need for pressing;
- observe precautions while pressing;
- take adequate care while folding and packing.

3.4 NEED

As mentioned earlier, the final finishing of any garment is done by pressing. This makes the garment took attractive. Pressing is essential because -

1. It saves time

The fabric which is bought from the market is usually creased. If the garment is made from this creased cloth, we will waste time in opening and redoing the seams when the fitting is not proper. Hence it is better to remove all creases from the cloth by ironing it before cutting. Ironing is also done where tacking is done, for example, when folding for a hem, the cloth can be pressed while it is being evenly folded. In this way one can save time while hemming and the work will also be neater.

2. It gives a neat finish

Minor defects in stitching can easily be removed by pressing. The seams are pressed into place and this gives the garment a neat finish.

3. It gives a complete took

There are some garments which are fitted at some places, loose at other places and a tension is given at some places. Without pressing, a good fitting cannot be achieved, nor do the gathers fall properly. It is only when the garment is pressed that a compete, attractive look is obtained. Hence pressing a garment after making it is an essential step.

13.4 PRECAUTIONS WHILE PRESSING

It is essential to press the garment in order to give it a good shape. There are many processes in dress making like -cutting is a process, binding is another, finishing edges is another process. At every step, one needs to press.

There are different ways of pressing different garments. One needs to have knowledge of these different ways otherwise the garment may get burnt. Hence, the following precautions should be observed while pressing :

1. Before pressing, test the press on a waste piece of cloth to see whether the sole of the press is rusted or not. If the sole is rusted, clean the rust with a piece of wax and then press the garment.

2. Check to see that the press is not dusty or dirty otherwise the garment will be soiled. Always keep the press clean.

3. Check to see the electrical wires of the press. If there is a leak of current, get it repaired before use. Make sure there are no naked wires.

4. Keep the switch of the plug point off. Switch it on only after inserting the plug.

5. Test the temperature of the press on a discarded piece of cloth of the garment. If it is too hot, it may burn the garment.

6. The temperature and weight of the press should be according to the requirement of the garment. Some garments need a heavy press and some need a light press. The same is the case with temperature.

7. Set the temperature regulator on an automatic press according to the fabric of the garment.

8. Keep the basin of water on the right hand side and in a place so that it does not splash.

9. Rest the press on an iron stand. If the press table has a stand for the press, place a piece of asbestos on it while using it.

10. Do not sprinkle water on the garment. If needed, moisten the fabric with a sponge.

11. Use a soft, dry piece of mulmul when pressing over the metallic parts of garments. Never press them without covering otherwise they will be tarnished.

12. Press the seams from the wrong side of the garment when pressing during stitching.

13. Place a wet cloth over woollen garments while pressing otherwise the soft fibers will get burnt.

14. Piled fabric should be pressed with a steam press or by pinning on a needle board. They should be pressed keeping the right sides facing.

15. Woollen garments should be brushed to get rid of the dust before pressing. A wet cloth should be placed over the garment while pressing.

16. The person doing pressing should always wear rubber slippers or stand on a wooden board. This prevents the possibility of an electric shock.

17. The person doing pressing should always keep the hand dry.

PRECAUTIONS AFTER PRESSING

1. Switch off the mains and remove the plug from the socket.

2. Place the press in its proper place after cooling it.

3. Check the press and wires before putting it away.

4. Never put away a hot press in an almirah.

INTEXT QUESTIONS 13.1

State whether the following statements are true or false :-

i) Keep the basin of water on the left while pressing.

ii) Piled fabrics should be pressed with a steam press.

iii) The temperature and weight of the press should be according to the garment.

iv) The press should be checked before pressing.

v) Woollen garments should be ironed directly.

vi) All the different parts of a garment need to be pressed repeatedly.

13.5 FOLDING AND PACKING

Every garment needs to be folded properly after pressing. If the garment is to be used at home it can be hung up on a hanger. But for garments which have to be sent to be sold in the market or which have to be handed over to the customer, folding becomes a necessity.

13.6 NEED

1. The garment does not become crushed if it is properly folded after pressing.
2. The garment looks presentable and attractive.
3. A folded garment takes up less space.
4. It is easy to transport folded garments to the market.
5. Folded garment can be easily stored for long periods.

Various garments are folded in various ways, e.g. upper body garments and lower body garments.

i) Upper body garments

a) Gents shirt

A cardboard or plastic piece in the shape of a band is inserted below the fold of the collar-this holds up the collar and maintains the shape. Taking the neck point and the center point of the arm hole as the base, both sides are folded back and then both the sleeves are properly folded over so that the collar is properly visible.

b) Ladies shirt

The entire shirt is first pressed properly and then the sides are folded back along the crease line. The sleeves are then folded and set over the folded part of the shirt. The shirt is then folded in half, crease lines are properly set and the shirt is then packed.

ii) Lower body garments

The inner and outer seams are kept together and the crease is set by pressing. If the garment is to be packed in boxes, then a three fold is made length wise and the garment packed in polythene bags and put into boxes.

13.7 PRECAUTIONS WHILE FOLDING

The following precautions must be observed while folding :

1. A cardboard or plastic band should be used under the collar while folding a gents shirt.
2. The crease should not be disturbed while folding.
3. The garment should have uniform creases.
4. The garment should be folded only after proper pressing.
5. Every garment should first be folded widthwise and then folded twice or thrice lengthwise, as may be required.
6. The neckline part of the garment should be on the front.
7. The garment should not be unnecessarily folded at any part while packing.
8. A garment needs to be folded more if it is to be packed in a box and it needs less folds if it is to be packed in a polythene bag.
9. A paper or cardboard should be used while folding children garments.
10. A garment should be properly packed after folding.

13.8 WHAT YOU HAVE LEARNT

In this lesson you have learnt about the need for pressing and about the precautions to be observed while pressing and folding garments.

Do and see

Press and fold the following garments according to the procedure given -

(i) Gents Shirts

(ii) Ladies Shirts

13.9 TERMINAL EXERCISE

1. Describe the precautions to be observed while pressing garments.

13.10 ANSWERS TO INTEXT QUESTIONS

13.1

i)	False	ii)	True
iii)	True	iv)	True
v)	False	vi)	False